

Switzerland & Italy

Interactive Travel Guide v5 · Oct 1–12, 2026 · 2 Travelers

Mumbai → Zurich → Lucerne → Interlaken → Milan → CT → Florence → Siena → Rome → Mumbai

12

DAYS

8

CITIES

2

COUNTRIES

15

PDF PAGES

₹2.7L

BOOKED

₹5.95L

EST. TOTAL

Download PDF Guide (202 KB, 15 pages)

Executive Trip Dashboard

Flight No	LX122
Route	BOM (Term E) → ZRH (Term E)
Date/Time	Wed Sep 30 03:40 → Thu Oct 1 00:50
PNR	Z5DY9C
Tickets	1Z4Z90Z579Z39 \ 1Z4Z90Z579Z40
Class	Economy
Baggage	1x3kg checked + 1x8kg cabin
Cost	₹7,76,525 (2 pax)
Check-in	Web check-in opens 48h before

Flight No	GF56 (FCO → BAH) + GF56 (BAH → BOM)
Route	BOM → FCO → BAH → BAH → FCO → BOM
Schedule	FCO 15:40 → BAH 19:50 \ BAH 05:35 → BOM 02:10
Layover	BAH 19:50 → 05:35 (7h 12min)
PNR	UYWIKY
Tickets	01Z482Z463386 \ 01Z482Z463387
Cost	₹69,372 (2 pax)
Notes	Overnight layover in Bahrain. Re-check pads.

Booking Progress

8 of 21 items complete (updated food budget)

₹2,69,992

Spent so far

8 done

13 pending

38% complete

Flights (2/2)

☒ LX155 BOM → ZRH
PNR Z5DY9C, ₹77,625

☒ GF26+56 FCO → BOM
PNR UYWIKY, ₹69,372

Hotels (6/7)

☒ INSIDE FIVE Zurich (Oct 1)
₹16,875 Booking.com

☒ Hotel Alpina Lucerne (Oct 2)
₹18,748 Booking.com

☒ Harder Minerva Interlaken (Oct 3)
₹21,562 free cancel Sep 19

☒ Milan Hotel (Oct 4)
Hotel Derna Via Tonale 14 ₹14,941

☒ Monterosso Hotel (Oct 5)
Hotel Palme Via IV Novembre 10 ₹18,678

☒ Florence Hotel (Oct 6-7)
Cardinal of Florence Borgo Pinti 5 ₹36,691

☒ Rome Hotel (Oct 8-12)
~₹96,000 (4nt), Torre Colonna 9.4

Museums & Activities (0/6)

☒ Last Supper (Oct 4 15:00)
€15/pp cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it

☒ Uffizi+Accademia (Oct 7)
~€52 uffizi.it

☒ Brunelleschi Pass Dome (Oct 7)
€30 duomo.firenze.it

☒ Vatican Museums (Oct 9 13:00)
~€22 ticket.museivaticani.va

☒ Borghese Gallery (Oct 10 15:00)
~€18 cultura.gov.it

☒ Colosseum (Oct 10 08:30)
€18-24 colosseo.it

Trains (0/3)

☒ EC 61 Interlaken → Milan (Oct 4)
From €23 trenitalia.com

☒ Milano → Monterosso direct
~€29 trenitalia.com

☒ Frecciarossa Florence → Rome (Oct 8)
From €14.90 trenitalia.com

Transport Cards (0/1)

Interactive Travel Guide

Tap on any city to expand its days. Tap a day for a full timeline. Tap an attraction for details.

Zurich

Oct 1



Day 1: Arrival + Zurich Old Town

Zurich was founded as the Roman customs post Turicum in 15 BC. The Grossmünster cathedral was founded, according to legend, after Charlemagne's horse stumbled on the graves of Zurich's patron saints Felix and Regula. The city is the birthplace of Dadaism (1916 at Cabaret Voltaire) and consistently ranks as the world's most liveable city.

1. Charlemagne's horse legend — the Grossmünster was founded after his horse kneeled at the saints' graves

2. Marc Chagall created Fraumünster's 5 stained-glass windows at age 83 in 1970

3. In 1292, Swiss women dressed as soldiers on Lindenhof to trick the Habsburg army

4. Dadaism was born at Cabaret Voltaire in 1916 — a deliberate rejection of logic after WWI

5. Bahnhofstrasse is one of the world's most expensive streets — rents exceed €7,000/m²/year

Timeline

06:20	LX155 lands Schengen arrival. Customs ~30min. Follow signs to baggage + train station below Arrivals level 0.	—
07:10–07:24	IR train to ZRH HB Platforms below Arrivals. Trains every 8-10 min. 14 min ride. 50% off with Half Fare Card.	HFC
08:00–08:45	Breakfast @ Sprüngli Paradeplatz. Legendary café. Try Luxemburgerli macarons (CHF 12-18). Mon-Sat 08:00-18:30.	CHF 12-18
09:00–09:30	Lindenhof Viewpoint Roman fort → medieval palace → best free Old Town panorama. Chestnut trees, chess tables.	FREE
10:00–10:30	Fraumünster Church 5 Chagall stained-glass windows in dreamlike blue, green, red. Entry CHF 5. 10:00-17:00.	CHF 5
10:30–11:30	Grossmünster Tower 187 steps for 360° Old Town + Alps view on clear days. CHF 5.	CHF 5
15:00	Check-in INSIDE FIVE Register 24h before via link from Booking.com. Upload passport. No front desk. +41 44 515 49 36.	Paid ₹16,875
16:00–17:00	Lake Zurich promenade Towards Zürichhorn. Swans on the lake. Red-eye recovery walk.	FREE
19:00+	Dinner Niederdorf alleys. Reserve ahead. Try Zürcher Geschnetzeltes (veal in cream sauce with rösti).	CHF 25-40

Attractions

Fraumünster Church

Chagall's 5 dreamlike stained-glass windows — blues, greens, reds depicting biblical scenes

Grossmünster

187 steps → 360° panoramic view of city, lake, and Alps + Romanesque crypt

Lindenhof Viewpoint

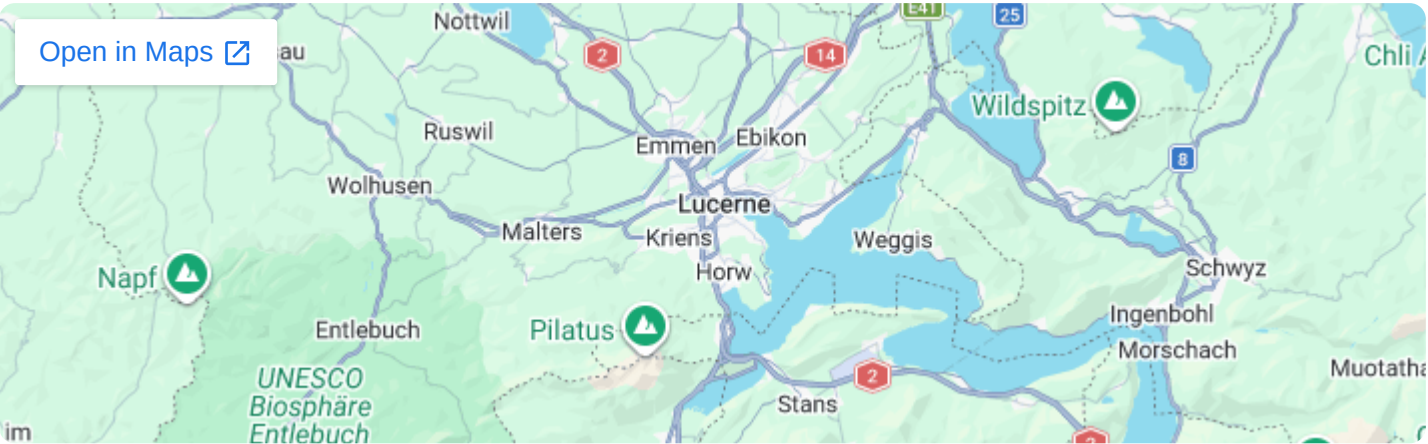
Best free viewpoint in Zurich + chestnut trees + chess tables

Sprüngli Café

Amazing hot chocolate + the original Luxemburgerli macaron

Lucerne

Oct 2



Day 2: Lucerne — Chapel Bridge + Lake + Pilatus

Lucerne sits on Lake Lucerne (Vierwaldstättersee) with the Swiss Alps as backdrop. The Chapel Bridge (Kapellbrücke) is Europe's oldest surviving wooden bridge (1333), with 158 triangular 17th-century painted panels. The Lion Monument (1821) by Bertel Thorvaldsen commemorates 786 Swiss Guards killed in the French Revolution. Mark Twain called it "the most mournful and moving piece of stone in the world."

- 1. The Chapel Bridge nearly burned in 1993 — 78 of 158 painted panels were destroyed
- 2. Mt. Pilatus is named after Pontius Pilate — legend says his body was thrown into a lake here, causing storms
- 3. The Lion Monument is 10m × 6m, carved into a sandstone quarry face over 2 years
- 4. Musegg Wall (1408) was 870m with 30 towers — 9 survive, one of Europe's best-preserved medieval walls
- 5. Richard Wagner lived here 1866-1872, composing Die Meistersinger von Nürnberg at his Tribschen villa

Timeline

08:00–08:45	Breakfast + checkout Leaves bags at Hotel Alpina reception until 15:00.	CHF 10-15
09:10–09:51	SBB IR 70 → Lucerne Zurich HB → Lucerne. Every 30 min. 41 min ride. Sit LEFT for first lake glimpses. 50% HFC.	HFC
10:15–10:45	Chapel Bridge Europe's oldest (1333). 158 painted panels. 2 min walk from Hotel Alpina. FREE.	FREE
10:50–11:10	Lion Monument Mark Twain's "saddest piece of stone." Carved 1821. FREE.	FREE
11:15–11:45	Weinmarkt + Old Town Painted facades. Medieval squares. The most photographed square in Lucerne.	FREE

Mt. Pilatus Golden Round Trip (clear weather)

12:00–12:30	Bus #1 → Kriens
12:30–13:00	Dragon Ride gondola
13:00–14:00	Summit
14:00–14:40	World's steepest cogwheel
15:00–16:15	Lake cruise → Lucerne

Relaxed Lucerne + Lake Cruise

12:00–12:45	Lunch on promenade
12:12–13:00	SGV boat → Weggis
13:00–13:40	Explore Weggis
13:45–14:30	Return cruise
15:30–17:00	Musegg Wall

Attractions

Chapel Bridge (Kapellbrücke)

Europe's oldest surviving wooden bridge + 17th-century painted panels + iconic Alpine backdrop

Lion Monument

Most famous sculpture in Switzerland + deep historical meaning

Mt. Pilatus Golden Round Trip

World's steepest cogwheel + lake cruise + panoramic Alpine views

Musegg Wall

Best-preserved medieval wall in Switzerland + free tower climbs

Interlaken

Oct 3



Day 3: Interlaken + Jungfrauoch — Top of Europe

Interlaken means "between lakes" — it sits on a strip between Lake Thun and Lake Brienz. The Jungfrau Railway opened in 1912 after 16 years of construction through the Eiger and Mönch mountains. Workers lived in the tunnel for months. At 3,454m, Jungfrauoch is the highest railway station in Europe. The Sphinx Observation Deck (3,571m) offers a 360° panoramic view of the Aletsch Glacier (23km, UNESCO), the longest in the Alps. The Ice Palace has tunnels carved 20m into the glacier.

- 1. The Jungfrau Railway took 16 years (1896-1912) blasting through the Eiger and Mönch
- 2. The Eiger North Face is called "Mordwand" (Murder Wall) — 60+ climbers have died since 1935
- 3. The Aletsch Glacier has receded 3.6km since 1870 — losing ~50m/year, may disappear by 2100
- 4. The Harder Kulm funicular (1908) has a 64% gradient — closed for maintenance in 2026
- 5. Interlaken hosts 20,000+ tandem paragliding flights annually

Timeline

08:00–08:45	Breakfast + checkout	Leave bags at Hotel Alpina reception.	CHF 10-15
09:04–10:59	Lucerne → Interlaken Ost	Luzern-Interlaken Express. Hourly. 1h55min. !! Sit RIGHT for Lake Brienz views !!	HFC
11:00–11:15	Drop bags	Hotel Harder Minerva. 5 min walk from Ost. Check-in 15:00. Bag storage available.	—
11:30–12:15	Quick lunch	Migros near Ost station or station bakery. Grab-and-go.	CHF 15-25
12:32–13:04	BOB → Grindelwald	Berner Oberland Bahn. 32 min. Train splits at Zweilütschinen — board rear section.	HFC
13:04–13:19	Eiger Express	15 min cable car with glass floor. Scenic ascent through Eiger North Face.	Incl.
13:19–13:27	Cogwheel to summit	8 min through the Eiger tunnel to 3,454m!	Incl.
13:27–16:30	JUNGFRAUJOCH (3h)	Sphinx Deck → Ice Palace → Alpine Sensation → Plateau → Chocolate Paradise. Don't miss last descent at ~16:45!	CHF 130.60
16:30–17:25	Descent	Jungfrauoch → Interlaken Ost. ~55 min.	Incl.
17:30	Check-in	Harder Minerva. Rest after summit.	—
19:00+	Dinner	Hirschen or Hüsi Bierhaus. Reserve ahead.	CHF 30-45

☐ Attractions

Jungfrauoch — Top of Europe

Europe's highest station + 360° Sphinx view + Ice Palace + Aletsch Glacier + free Lindt at Chocolate Paradise

Sphinx Observation Deck

Highest viewpoint accessible by public transport in Europe

Ice Palace

Walk inside a glacier

Aletsch Glacier

Longest Alpine glacier + UNESCO — see it before it's gone

☐☐ Milan

Oct 4



Day 4: Milan — Last Supper + Duomo

Milan (Mediolanum) was founded by Celts in 600 BC. It became capital of the Western Roman Empire in 286 AD. Under the Sforza dukes (1450-1499), it was a Renaissance powerhouse. Leonardo da Vinci spent 17 years here, painting The Last Supper on a refractory wall. The Duomo took 579 years (1386-1965) and is the largest church in Italy. Milan is home to La Scala, the Italian stock exchange, and fashion houses Prada, Versace, Armani, and Dolce & Gabbana.

- 1. Leonardo's Last Supper was painted in oil-tempera on dry plaster — a failed experiment that started deteriorating in his lifetime
- 2. The Duomo took 579 years to build — Napoleon accelerated construction in 1805 for his coronation
- 3. The Duomo has 3,400 statues, 135 spires, and 700 gargoyles — the Madonnina at 108.5m is a Milan icon
- 4. Locals spin their heel on the Galleria's mosaic bull testicles — 3 spins = guaranteed return to Milan (20cm hole worn!)
- 5. Aperitivo culture was born in Milan — Campari was created here in 1860

☐ Timeline

08:00–09:00	☐ Breakfast + checkout Harder Minerva. Leave Interlaken.	CHF 10-15
09:33–12:48	☐ EC 61 → Milano Centrale EuroCity via Spiez → Brig → Domodossola. Crosses into Italy! Book Jul 2026, from €23.	From €23
12:48–13:30	☐ Drop bags Metro M2 or M3 from Centrale to hotel.	—
13:30–14:15	☐ Lunch near SMG Quick pasta near Santa Maria delle Grazie. 5 min walk.	€12-20
14:30–14:45	☐ Arrive SMG 30 min early. Photo ID required. No large bags.	—
15:00–15:15	☐ THE LAST SUPPER ☐ Book late Jun/Jul 2026! cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it. 15 min exactly. €15/pp.	€15
15:30–15:50	☐ Walk to Duomo Via Torino, 20 min walk.	FREE
16:00–17:00	☐ Duomo Rooftop Stairs €13 (250 steps). Golden hour! Last entry 18:00.	€13
17:00–18:00	☐ Duomo Interior 5 naves. 3,400 statues. St. Bartholomew's flayed skin statue.	€3
18:00–19:00	☐ Galleria + bull spin Spin the bull's testicles! Galleria terrace €12 optional.	FREE/€12
19:00+	☐ Dinner Navigli canals (M2 Porta Genova). Sunday aperitivo culture!	€25-40

☐ Attractions

The Last Supper (Cenacolo Vinciano)

One of the most famous paintings in the world + Leonardo's revolutionary perspective composition

Milan Duomo

579 years of construction + rooftop with golden city views + 3,400 statues

Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II

Stunning 19th-century glass-vaulted arcade + the bull testicle tradition

Santa Maria delle Grazie

UNESCO World Heritage + home of The Last Supper + Bramante's architecture

 Cinque Terre

Oct 5-6



Day 5: Cinque Terre Arrival + Monterosso

Cinque Terre — the "Five Lands" — is a UNESCO site of 5 medieval fishing villages clinging to the Ligurian coast. No cars reach the villages except Monterosso. The terraced vineyards were built by hand over 800 years with 6,730km of stone walls (longer than the Great Wall of China). Monterosso is the only one with a proper sandy beach. Vernazza has the most photogenic harbor.

- 1. The stone walls on the terraced vineyards total 6,730km — longer than the Great Wall of China
- 2. The villages are almost entirely car-free — only Monterosso has car traffic, and very limited
- 3. Via dell'Amore (Lover's Lane) between Riomaggiore and Manarola was built for railway workers in the 1920s
- 4. Monterosso is famous for its anchovies — salted and preserved in oil — sold everywhere
- 5. Liguria is the birthplace of focaccia — the original Genovese version is soft, salty, and perfect with pesto

 Timeline

08:00–09:00	 Breakfast + checkout Hotel Harder Minerva. Walk to Ost station.	CHF 10-15
09:33–12:48	 EC 61 Milano Interlaken Ost → Milano Centrale. Book Jul 2026!	From €23
10:35–13:22	 Milano → Monterosso Direct IC train. Sit RIGHT after Genova for coastal views! ~3h. Book Jul/Aug.	~€29
13:30–14:30	 Check-in + lunch  Confirm bag drop with hotel. No left luggage at CT stations!	€15-25

 Relaxed Beach Day

14:30–16:30  Monterosso beach

16:30–17:30  Gelato + passeggiata

 Hike Monterosso → Vernazza **Recommended**

14:30–16:00  Sentiero Azzurro hike

16:00–16:40  Vernazza harbor

 Attractions

Sentiero Azzurro (Blue Trail)

Most scenic coastal hike in Italy + UNESCO + village-to-village

Monterosso al Mare

Sandy beach + Old Town + best base for exploring CT

Vernazza

Most photogenic village + natural harbor + sunset views



Day 6: CT Morning Hike → Florence Arrival

Florence is the cradle of the Renaissance. In the 15th century, the Medici family transformed it into the most culturally explosive place on Earth. In one generation: Brunelleschi's Dome (the largest masonry dome ever), Donatello's David, Masaccio's frescoes, and a young Leonardo da Vinci apprenticed in Verrocchio's workshop. The Uffizi has the world's finest Renaissance collection.

Timeline

08:30–10:00	Morning hike Monterosso → Vernazza on Sentiero Azzurro. Morning light =	€7.50
10:00–10:20	Vernazza goodbye Last look at the colorful harbour.	FREE
10:20–10:30	CT Express back Vernazza → Monterosso. 7 min.	CT Card
10:30–11:00	Checkout Pack. Walk to station.	—
11:25–11:45	Monterosso → La Spezia CT Express. 20 min. 34 min buffer before Frecciarossa!	CT Card
12:19–13:47	Frecciarossa → Firenze SMN La Spezia → Florence. 1h28min at 300km/h. Book Sep.	~€20-30
14:00–14:30	Check-in Hotel near SMN or Duomo. Drop bags.	—
15:00–16:00	Santa Croce Tombs of Michelangelo, Galileo, Machiavelli. Closes 17:30.	€12
16:00–16:40	Ponte Vecchio Jewelry-lined medieval bridge (1345). Vasari Corridor above.	FREE
17:00–17:45	San Miniato al Monte GO FIRST! Romanesque marble. Plainsong chant ~17:30. FREE. Closes 18:00.	FREE
17:45–18:30	Piazzale Michelangelo SUNSET ~18:11 Classic Florence panorama. Bring wine!	FREE
19:00+	Dinner Oltrarno neighborhood. Reserve ahead.	€20-35

Attractions

San Miniato al Monte

Best free viewpoint of Florence + Romanesque architecture + Gregorian chant

Piazzale Michelangelo

Most famous Florence panorama + sunset over the Duomo

Ponte Vecchio

Oldest bridge in Florence + jewelry shops + WWII history

Santa Croce Basilica

Tomb of Renaissance giants + Giotto's frescoes

Florence

Oct 6-7



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Attractions

San Miniato al Monte

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Piazzale Michelangelo

Most famous Florence panorama + sunset over the Duomo

Ponte Vecchio

Oldest bridge in Florence + jewelry shops + WWII history

Santa Croce Basilica

Tomb of Renaissance giants + Giotto's frescoes



Day 7: Florence Art Marathon — Uffizi + Accademia + Dome

1. Brunelleschi's Dome was built with a herringbone brick pattern that supports itself — no external scaffolding
2. Michelangelo was 26 when he carved David from a block of Carrara marble two earlier sculptors rejected
3. Ponte Vecchio is the only Florentine bridge the Nazis didn't destroy in 1944 — Hitler ordered it spared
4. Peposo (beef slow-cooked in black pepper) was Brunelleschi's workers' meal during Dome construction
5. Florence churches enforce strict dress codes — shoulders and knees covered at all times

Timeline

08:15–10:15	📍 UFFIZI GALLERY First slot = least crowded! Botticelli, Leonardo, Caravaggio, Raphael. Book Aug-Sep. ~€40.	~€40
10:30–11:15	📍 ACCADEMIA — David Michelangelo's David! 45 min enough. Pre-book 10:30 slot. ~€12.	~€12
11:30–12:30	📍 DOME CLIMB 463 steps! No elevator. Brunelleschi Pass €30 (includes Baptistry, Campanile, museum). Book Aug-Sep.	€30
12:30–13:00	📍 Duomo Interior Free. Vasari's Last Judgment fresco on the dome interior. Shoulders + knees covered.	FREE
13:00–14:00	📍 Lunch @ Mercato Centrale Upper floor food hall. 20+ stalls. €10-18 feast!	€10-18
14:00–15:30	📍 Oltrarno walk Ponte Vecchio → Palazzo Pitti → Santo Spirito → Via Maggio	FREE/€5
15:30–16:30	📍 San Lorenzo Market Leather goods, souvenirs.	FREE
17:30	📍 San Miniato (backup) Closes 18:00. Plainsong 17:30 if missed yesterday.	FREE
19:00+	📍 Final Florence dinner Try Bistecca alla Fiorentina! Reserve ahead.	€20-35

📍 Attractions

Uffizi Gallery

Most important Renaissance art collection on Earth + Botticelli + Leonardo + Caravaggio

Accademia — David

The most famous sculpture in the world + Michelangelo at 26

Brunelleschi's Dome

Engineering miracle of the Renaissance + 360° Florence view

Florence Baptistry

Ghiberti's "Gates of Paradise" + Dante's baptism site

📍 Siena

Oct 8 (day)



Day 8: Siena Day Trip → Rome Transfer

Siena is a perfectly preserved medieval city — Florence's great rival. The shell-shaped Piazza del Campo is Europe's finest medieval square. Twice a year, it hosts the Palio, a bareback horse race since 1147. The Duomo's mosaic floor took 200 years. The entire historic centre is UNESCO-listed.

- 1. The Palio has been run bareback since 1147 — 3 laps around the sloping Piazza del Campo, 90 seconds of chaos
- 2. Siena defeated Florence at the Battle of Montaperti (1260) — Florence finally annexed them in 1555
- 3. The Black Death of 1348 halved Siena's population and stopped the expansion of the Duomo
- 4. The Duomo's 56-panel mosaic floor took from 1369 to 1547 to complete
- 5. Siena's city walls (Cinta Senese) are 7km long with 7 gates

📍 Timeline

07:00–08:00	📍 Breakfast + store bags Leave luggage at Florence hotel. Collect after Siena.	—
08:30–09:45	📍 Bus 131R → Siena From Autostazione (behind SMN). Arrive 10 min early — buses fill up!	€7-9
10:00–10:30	📍 Piazza del Campo Shell-shaped square. Torre del Mangia. Palio runs here.	FREE

10:30–11:30	🕒 Siena Duomo 56-panel mosaic floor. Piccolomini Library frescoes. €10-15.	€10-15
11:30–12:15	🕒 Torre del Mangia climb 400 steps. Panoramic countryside views.	€10
12:15–13:00	🕒 Lunch Pici cacio e pepe (Siena's thick spaghetti).	€10-15
13:30–14:45	🕒 Bus 131R return ⚠️ Walk uphill to station takes time. Be at stop by 13:15!	€7-9
14:45–15:10	🕒 Collect luggage Walk to hotel, grab bags.	—
16:00–17:28	🕒 Frecciarossa → Rome Firenze SMN → Roma Termini. 1h28min at 300km/h. Book Jul! From €14.90.	From €14.90
17:30–18:00	🕒 Check-in Rome Home for 4 nights.	—
19:00–20:00	🕒 Trevi Fountain (night) Lit up after dark 🕒 Fewer crowds. Magic atmosphere.	FREE
🕒 Attractions		
Piazza del Campo Europe's finest medieval square + Palio history + 400-step tower climb		
Siena Duomo One of Italy's most beautiful cathedrals + mosaic floor + library frescoes		
Torre del Mangia Best panoramic view of Siena + Tuscan countryside		

🕒 Rome

Oct 8-12

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📌 Attractions		
Piazza del Campo		
Europe's finest medieval square + Palio history + 400-step tower climb		
Siena Duomo		
One of Italy's most beautiful cathedrals + mosaic floor + library frescoes		
Torre del Mangia		
Best panoramic view of Siena + Tuscan countryside		

Day 9: Vatican City — St. Peter's + Dome + Museums

Vatican City (44 hectares, ~800 citizens) is the smallest independent state on Earth — and holds the world's greatest art collection, amassed by popes over 500 years. St. Peter's Basilica is the largest church in the world. The Vatican Museums have 7km of corridors.

1. The Vatican Museums have 7km of corridors — 30 seconds each piece = 12 years to see everything

2. St. Peter's Basilica took 120 years to build (1506-1626) — architects included Bramante, Raphael, Michelangelo, Bernini

3. Michelangelo painted the Sistine Chapel ceiling (1508-1512) mostly lying down on scaffolding he designed himself

4. The Vatican has its own post office, helipad, railway station, bank, and pharmacy

5. The Sistine Chapel's Last Judgment took Michelangelo 6 years (1536-1541) working alone — he painted it at age 66

Timeline

06:30–07:00

Early breakfast

Start early for empty St. Peter's.

—

07:00–07:30

St. Peter's Basilica

Opens 07:00 — NO QUEUE! FREE. Michelangelo's Pietà (his only signed work), Bernini's baldachin. Dress code: shoulders + knees.

FREE

07:30–08:15

St. Peter's Dome

551 steps. Elevator €15 (saves 231) or stairs €10. ⚠ Oct hours: 07:30-17:00. Do it early!

€10/€15

08:15–08:45

Papal tombs

Tomb of St. Peter, papal tombs beneath the basilica.

FREE

09:00–09:30

Castel Sant'Angelo ext.

Hadrian's mausoleum (139 AD). Walk along Tiber.

FREE

10:30–11:30

Piazza Navona

Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers (Nile, Ganges, Danube, Río de la Plata).

FREE

11:30–12:00

Pantheon

Best preserved Roman building. 9m oculus — rain falls through!

€5

12:00–13:00

Lunch

Quick pasta near Vatican.

€12-20

13:00–17:30

VATICAN MUSEUMS

4.5h. Pre-book 13:00 slot. Sistine Chapel (last 30 min ☐), Raphael Rooms, Gallery of Maps. Book Aug-Sep!

~€22

17:45–18:15

St. Peter's Square

Evening light on Bernini's 284-column colonnade.

FREE

19:00+

Dinner

Trastevere. Roman classics: cacio e pepe, carbonara. Reserve ahead!

€25-40

Attractions

St. Peter's Basilica

Largest church in the world + Michelangelo's Pietà + Dome view of Rome

Sistine Chapel

Michelangelo's most famous work + The Creation of Adam + entire Renaissance in one room

Vatican Museums

One of the world's greatest art collections + Raphael Rooms + Gallery of Maps

Pantheon

1,900-year-old engineering marvel + perfect dome + tombs of Raphael and Italian kings



Day 10: Ancient Rome — Colosseum + Forum + Borghese

- 1. The Colosseum had 80 numbered arches and could empty 50,000 spectators in 10 minutes — modern stadiums can't match this
- 2. Bernini carved Apollo and Daphne (Borghese) at age 22 — the marble leaves are so thin light shines through
- 3. The Trevi Fountain uses 80,000 m³ daily from the Acqua Vergine aqueduct (19 BC) — €3,000 collected daily goes to charity
- 4. Via dei Fori Imperiali is built on top of ancient Roman excavations — archaeologists are still digging underneath
- 5. Romans eat cacio e pepe with only 3 ingredients: pecorino, black pepper, pasta — perfect simplicity

Timeline

08:30–10:30	Colosseum First slot = cooler + less crowded! Arena floor upgrade (€24) lets you stand where gladiators fought. Pre-book Sep.	€18/24
10:30–12:00	Forum + Palatine Hill Arch of Titus, Via Sacra, Senate House, Temple of Caesar, Domus Augustana. Included in Colosseum ticket.	Incl.
12:00–12:15	Via dei Fori Imperiali Looking down at ongoing Roman excavations.	FREE
12:15–12:45	Trevi Fountain Throw coin right hand over left shoulder	FREE
12:45–13:45	Lunch Near Trevi area.	€12-20
14:00–14:40	Walk to Borghese Through Villa Borghese park (80 hectares, Rome's green lung).	FREE
15:00–17:00	Borghese Gallery Bernini's Apollo & Daphne, Rape of Proserpina. Caravaggio's Medusa, David with Goliath. Strict: max 360 ppl/2h. Arrive 14:40! Book Jul/Aug.	~€18
17:30–19:00	Spanish Steps Dolce Vita walk. Climb for sunset over Rome.	FREE
19:30+	Dinner Testaccio or Trastevere.	€25-40

Attractions

Colosseum

The most iconic ancient Roman structure + gladiator history + 1,950 years old

Roman Forum + Palatine Hill

The center of the Roman Empire for 1,000 years + where Julius Caesar was cremated

Borghese Gallery

Bernini at 22 + Caravaggio masterpieces + intimate setting (only 360 people per slot)

Trevi Fountain

Most famous fountain in the world + Baroque masterpiece + La Dolce Vita



Day 11: Rome Relaxed + Final Day

Timeline

08:00–09:00	Breakfast One last cappuccino at a sidewalk café. (Never after 11am — Italian rule!)	~€5
09:30–10:00	Trevi morning light Fewer crowds + morning light = better photos than evening	FREE
10:00–11:00	Spanish Steps Window-shopping on Via Condotti. Highest-end fashion.	FREE
13:00–14:30	Aventine Keyhole Knights of Malta keyhole → perfectly framed St. Peter's. Then Orange Garden (Giardino degli Aranci) — best free Rome view	FREE
14:30–16:00	Last passeggiata Your choice: Piazza Navona, Trastevere alleys, or one final visit.	FREE
17:00–18:00	Collect luggage Back to hotel.	—
19:00+	FINAL DINNER Splurge! Reserve the best table. Cacio e pepe, carbonara, amatriciana. Finish with limoncello.	€30-45

Attractions

Aventine Keyhole + Orange Garden

Rome's best secret view + perfect keyhole frame + free Orange Garden sunset



Day 12: Departure — Rome → Mumbai

Timeline

07:30–08:00	☐ One last caffè Final Italian espresso. (Never cappuccino after 11am!)	~€3
08:00–09:00	☐ Last souvenirs Final walk. Last-minute shopping.	—
09:00–09:15	☐ Walk to Termini From central hotels, 15 min walk.	—
09:20–09:52	☐ Leonardo Express → FCO Non-stop to FCO. Every 15 min. Buy at Termini machines (€14). Keep ticket until exit!	€14
10:00–12:30	☐ Security + boarding At gate by 11:45. 2h40m buffer.	—
12:40–19:20	✈ GF26 → Bahrain FCO → BAH. 6h40m. Overnight layover.	Booked
22:45–02:35+1	☐ BAH layover 7h50m at Bahrain Airport. Restaurants, shops, lounges.	—
02:35–05:10+1	✈ GF56 → BOM BAH → BOM. Arrive Tue Oct 13, 05:10 IST ☐	Booked

☐ Gastronomic Directory

Curated restaurant recommendations by city, with signature dishes and reservation info.

☐ Zurich

Sprüngli ☐

Luxemburgerli macarons + hot chocolate · CHF 12-18
 Paradeplatz. Legendary Zurich café since 1836. Try 15 flavours of Luxemburgerli.

Zeughauskeller ☐

Zürcher Geschnetzeltes · CHF 25-40
 Historic armory building. Veal in cream + mushroom sauce with rösti. Huge portions. [☐ Reserve](#)

Coop/Migros ☐

Ready meals, salads · CHF 5-8
 Budget lifesaver. Located at every station. Perfect for quick lunch.

☐ Lucerne

Rathaus Brauerei ☐

Fondue + own craft beer · CHF 25-40
 Brewery since 1863. Lake terrace. Swiss classics. [☐ Reserve](#)

Wirtshaus Taube ☐

Chügelipastete · CHF 20-35
 Creamed veal in puff pastry dome. Local favorite. Traditional atmosphere.

Fondue House du Pont ☐

Cheese fondue · CHF 25-40
 Best fondue in Lucerne. Near Chapel Bridge. [☐ Reserve](#)

☐ Interlaken

Hirschen ☐

Rösti + fondue · CHF 25-40
 Traditional Swiss. 5 min from Harder Minerva. [☐ Reserve](#)

Hüsi Bierhaus ☐

Hearty meals · CHF 20-30
 Casual pub vibe. Good beers.

Jungfrauoch Panorama ☐

Hot meals at summit · CHF 20-35
 Open 11:30-16:00. Eat at the Top of Europe!

▣ Milan

Luini ▣

Fried panzerotti · ~€5

Via Santa Antonio. Famous since 1888. Queue moves fast. Must try!

Trattoria Trippa ▣

Risotto alla Milanese · €30-45

By Chef Diego Rossi. Best Milanese restaurant. Book via website.

▣ Reserve

Miscusi ▣

Fresh pasta daily · €12-18

Modern pasta chain. Good value. Multiple locations.

Navigli aperitivo ▣

Drink + free buffet · €10-15

Buy a drink, get a free dinner buffet. Milanese tradition since the 19th century.

▣ Cinque Terre

Da Miky ▣

Mixed seafood grill · €25-40

Best seafood in CT. Monterosso harbour. Book ahead! ▣

▣ Reserve

Belforte ▣

Squid ink pasta · €20-35

Vernazza. Suspended over the harbour. 13th-century castle setting.

▣ Reserve

Nessun Dorma ▣

Wine + focaccia · €15-20

Vernazza sunset terrace. Perfect for aperitivo with a view.

▣ Florence

All'Antico Vinaio ▣

€8 schiacciata sandwich · ~€8

Legendary sandwich shop near Uffizi. Queue always around the block. Worth it.

Mercato Centrale ▣

20+ food stalls · €10-18

Upper floor food hall. Pizza, pasta, wine, gelato, dessert — everything in one place.

Trattoria Nella ▣

Tuscan classics · €15-25

Local favorite. Simple, authentic, honest Tuscan food. Quirky owner.

▣ Reserve

Bistecca alla Fiorentina ▣

T-bone steak · €30-50

Florence's signature dish. 1kg+ Chianina beef. Reserve at any good Oltrarno trattoria. ▣ Reserve

Gelateria dei Neri ▣

Artisanal gelato · ~€4-7

Often ranked #1 in Florence. Near Santa Croce.

▣ Siena

Osteria Boccon del Prete ▣

Pici with wild boar · €15-25

Best in Siena. Traditional Sienese. Reserve ahead. ▣ Reserve

Nannini ▣

Panforte + ricciarelli · ~€8-12

Historic café since 1870. Try panforte (Sienese fruitcake).

▣ Rome

Da Enzo ▣

Cacio e pepe · €25-35

Agustarello ▣

Amatriciana · €20-30

Trastevere. Roman trattoria. Must reserve days ahead. The cacio e pepe is legendary. [Reserve](#)

Testaccio. Family-run since 1960. Best amatriciana in Rome. [Reserve](#)

Flavio al Velavevodetto

Carbonara · €25-40

Testaccio legend. Real Roman carbonara (NO cream!). [Reserve](#)

Pastificio

€4 fresh pasta · ~€4

Near Trevi. Takeaway. €4 for high quality fresh pasta. Budget lifesaver.

Gelateria del Teatro

Artisanal gelato · ~€4-7

Near Piazza Navona. Creative flavors. Organic ingredients.

Threat Mitigation & City Safety

City-specific scams, security risks, and how to avoid them.

Zurich

Low Risk

Very safe city

Low pickpocket risk. Normal caution near HB. Safe to walk at night.

INSIDE FIVE self check-in

Must register 24h before with passport upload via Booking.com link. No front desk. Contact: +41 44 515 49 36.

Lucerne

Low Risk

Very safe

Tourist-friendly. Normal caution near station. Safe at night.

Pilatus weather

Check webcam before buying Golden Round Trip. If clouds obscure summit, skip — do the lake cruise instead.

Interlaken

Low Risk

Safe

Small town. Very safe. Normal precautions.

Jungfrauoch last descent

Last train down is ~16:45. Don't miss it — you'd be stranded overnight at 3,454m!

Milan

Medium Risk

Friendship bracelet scam

Men near Duomo tie a bracelet on your wrist and demand €10-20. Shake them off and walk fast.

Fake charity petitions

Person blocks your path with a clipboard. Sign → demand donation. Keep walking, say NO firmly.

⚠ Last Supper ticket touts

Resellers charge €50-100 for €15 tickets. Only buy from cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it

⚠ Taxi scam

Only take official white taxis with meters from ranks. Never accept rides from touts at Centrale.

📦 Pickpocket hotspots

Duomo square, Galleria, metro M1/M3, Centrale, tram #1. Keep valuables in front pockets.

📦 Cinque Terre

Low-Medium Risk

⚠ No left luggage

NO bag storage at any CT station! Confirm bag drop with Monterosso hotel before arriving.

⚠ Validate regional tickets

Must validate in green machines before boarding. Fine if caught without validation. App QR also works.

📦 Sentiero Azzurro safety

Wear proper shoes. Carry water. 90 min moderate. Not suitable in wet weather — slippery.

📦 Florence

Medium-High Risk

⚠ Bracelet scam near Duomo

Aggressive men tie bracelets on you, demand €10-20. Yell "NO!" and push past.

⚠ Gold ring scam

Someone "finds" a gold ring near you — accomplice lifts your bag while you look. Ignore and keep moving.

⚠ Pickpocket hotspots

Duomo square, Uffizi queue, Santa Croce, San Lorenzo market. Keep bags zipped.

⚠ Church dress code

Shoulders and knees covered. Guards at every church entrance. Women AND men. No exceptions.

📦 Rome

High Risk

⚠ Colosseum ticket touts

"Skip the line" sellers charge €50-100. Only buy from colosseo.it. The real price is €18-24.

⚠ Gladiator photo scam

Costumed gladiators near Colosseum charge €20-50 per photo. Take your own from a distance.

⚠ Vatican "official guides"

Fake staff near entrance. Only use tickets.museivaticani.va. Ignore clipboard people.

⚠ Rosary scam near Vatican

Someone hands you a "blessed" rosary then demands money. Don't take anything offered.

⚠ Metro + bus #64

Line A (Ottaviano → Termini) and bus 64 are famous pickpocket routes. Phones in front pockets.

⚠ ATM fee warning

Only use bank ATMs (Banco Posta, Unicredit). Avoid Euronet — high fees and terrible rates.

⚠ Dynamic currency conversion

When paying by card, ALWAYS choose EUR (not INR). DCC rates are trash.

🚉 Train & Transit Reference

All 12 train legs with exact numbers, times, and booking info.

#	ROUTE	TIME	DUR	COST	BOOK
IR / IC	ZRH Airport → ZRH HB	07:10-07:24	14 min	HFC 50% off	Walk-up. Platforms below Arrivals level 0
SBB IR 70	Zürich HB → Lucerne	09:10-09:51	41 min	HFC 50% off	Walk-up. Sit LEFT for lake glimpses
Luzern-Interlaken Express	Lucerne → Interlaken Ost	09:04-10:59	1h 55min	HFC 50% off	Walk-up. Sit RIGHT for Lake Brienz! ☐
BOB	Interlaken Ost → Grindelwald	12:32-13:04	32 min	HFC 50% off	Walk-up. Train splits at Zweilütschinen — rear section!
Eiger Express ☐	Grindelwald → Eigergletscher	13:04-13:19	15 min	Incl. Jungfrauoch ticket	Pre-booked. Glass floor cable car
Jungfrau Railway ☐	Eigergletscher → Jungfrauoch	13:19-13:27	8 min	CHF 130.60 (HFC)	Pre-book online. Through Eiger tunnel! ⚠ Last descent ~16:45
EC 61 EuroCity	Interlaken Ost → Milano Centrale	09:33-12:48	3h 15min	From €23	Jul 2026 trenitalia.com. Via Spiez → Brig → Domodossola
IC/RV Direct	Milano Centrale → Monterosso	10:35-13:22	~3h	~€29	Jul/Aug trenitalia.com. Sit RIGHT after Genova for coast views!
CT Express	Monterosso → La Spezia	11:25-11:45	20 min	CT Card / ~€5	Walk-up. 34 min buffer before Frecciarossa ⚠
Frecciarossa	La Spezia → Firenze SMN	12:19-13:47	1h 28min	~€20-30	Sep trenitalia.com. Fastest option via high-speed
Bus 131R	Firenze ↔ Siena	08:30-09:45 / 13:30-14:45	1h 15min	€7-9	Walk-up. From Autostazione behind SMN. ⚠ Be there early!
Frecciarossa	Firenze SMN → Roma Termini	16:00-17:28	1h 28min	From €14.90	Jul 2026 trenitalia.com. 300km/h high-speed!
Leonardo Express	Roma Termini → FCO Airport	09:20-09:52	32 min	€14 fixed	Buy at Termini machine. Non-stop. Keep ticket until exit FCO!

⚠ Jungfrauoch row highlighted. All times based on 2025 schedules — verify on SBB/Trenitalia ~90 days before.

📖 Master Booking & Logistics Ledger

✈ Flight Manifest

FLIGHT	ROUTE	DATE	TIME	PNR
LX155	BOM → ZRH	Oct 1	00:40-06:20	Z5DY9C

GF26	FCO → BAH	Oct 12	12:40-19:20	UYWIKY
GF56	BAH → BOM	Oct 13	02:35-05:10	UYWIKY

Accommodation Directory

Hotel	Address	Dates	Cost	Status
INSIDE FIVE City Apartments	Motorenstrasse 11, Zurich	Oct 1 (1 night)	₹16,875	☒ Booked
Hotel Alpina	Frankenstrasse 6, Lucerne	Oct 2 (1 night)	₹18,748	☒ Booked
Hotel Harder Minerva	Harderstrasse 15, Interlaken	Oct 3 (1 night)	₹21,562	☒ Booked
Hotel Derna	Via Tonale 14, Milan	Oct 4 (1 night)	₹14,941	☒ Booked
Hotel Palme	Via IV Novembre 10, Monterosso	Oct 5 (1 night)	₹18,678	☒ Booked
Cardinal of Florence	Borgo Pinti 5, Florence (San Marco)	Oct 6-7 (2 nights)	₹36,691	☒ Booked
Rome Hotel TBD	Near Termini or center	Oct 8-12 (4 nights)	~₹96,000	☐ Need to book
Total Hotels (booked)			₹2,23,495	6/7 done

Budget Estimate (Updated May 28)

Category	Amount	% of Total	Notes
✈ Flights (both)	₹1,46,997	24.5%	LX155 ₹77,625 + GF26/56 ₹69,372
☒ Hotels (6 booked)	₹1,27,495	21.1%	6 hotels across 7 nights
☒ Rome Hotel (4nt)	~₹96,000	16.0%	~₹24,000/nt — not yet booked
☒ Normal meals (11d × 2 pax)	₹66,000	11.0%	~₹3,000/day baseline
☒ Final dinner (Oct 11, Da Enzo)	+₹6,700	1.1%	€35×2 splurge
☒ Michelin-star (Bistrot 64 Rome)	+₹9,600	1.6%	5-course tasting €50×2
☒ 3× higher-end meals	+₹23,000	3.8%	Rome & Florence, €40-50×2×3
☒ Lindt chocolates	₹25,000	4.2%	Factory outlet, 2 pax
☒ Museums & Activities	~₹18,000	3.0%	~€150 total for all attractions
☒ Italy Trains	~₹8,500	1.4%	~€70 for all segments
☒ ☒ Swiss transport + HFC	~₹32,000	5.3%	2×HFC + half-price tickets
☒ Souvenirs & Shopping	₹25,000	4.2%	For both
☒ Misc (tips, snacks)	~₹20,000	3.3%	Padding
☒ GRAND TOTAL ESTIMATE	~₹6,04,500	100%	For 2 pax · 12 days · 8 cities

Activity & Rail Voucher Log

Item	Date	Slot	Cost	Book Via
☒ Last Supper	Oct 4	15:00	€15/pp	cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it
☒ Uffizi Gallery	Oct 7	08:15	~€40	uffizi.it
☒ Accademia (David)	Oct 7	10:30	~€12	galleriaaccademiafirenze.it
☒ Brunelleschi Pass	Oct 7	11:30	€30	duomo.firenze.it
☒ Vatican Museums	Oct 9	13:00	~€22	tickets.museivaticani.va
☒ Borghese Gallery	Oct 10	15:00	~€18	cultura.gov.it
☒ Colosseum	Oct 10	08:30	€18-24	colosseo.it
☒ ☒ Half Fare Card	Oct 1-4	—	CHF 120 → 150/pp	sbb.ch

❑ EC 61	Oct 4	09:33-12:48	From €23	trenitalia.com
❑ Frecciarossa	Oct 8	16:00-17:28	From €14.90	trenitalia.com

Created for Anurag & Poornima · Oct 1–12, 2026 · v5

Data verified: [cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it](#) · [ticket.museivaticani.va](#) · [uffizi.it](#) · [colosseo.it](#) · [sbb.ch](#) · [trenitalia.com](#) · [galleriaborghese.cultura.gov.it](#)